



THOMPSON RIVERS
UNIVERSITY
OPEN LEARNING

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ENGL 1001 • LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION I

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

TIME ALLOWED: 3 HOURS

TOTAL PAGES (INCLUDING THIS PAGE): 9

TOTAL MARKS: 100

MATERIALS PERMITTED:

- None

MATERIALS PROVIDED:

- Three exam answer booklets

**STUDENT: PLEASE COMPLETE THIS SECTION —
PRINT CLEARLY.**

Surname

First Name

Student Number

Open Learning Faculty Member's Name

Student's Signature (required)

Date

**OPEN LEARNING FACULTY MEMBER:
PLEASE COMPLETE THIS SECTION —
PRINT CLEARLY.**

Student's Mark _____ %

Name

I.D. Number

Signature

Date

Entered Into Portal: ___ Yes ___ No

Instructions

- Unless otherwise indicated, write all your answers in the exam answer booklets provided.
- When you have finished, **return all papers, including the exam and the exam answer booklets, in the envelope.** *Failure to do so may result in a FAIL grade.*

Students sometimes request old exams from the course. For security reasons, we do not give out old exams, but in this version of the course we have provided a sample exam.

The sample is for your reference only; do not submit it to your tutor for marking or comments.

There is a brief key at the end.

Note the format for the real exam may be somewhat different, but in general will resemble the sample.

- This examination contains nine (9) pages, including the cover sheet. Check to see that no pages are missing.
- You have three hours to complete the three parts of the exam. Allow yourself approximately 30 minutes for Part I, 60 minutes for Part II, and 90 minutes for Part III. Please read the instructions for each part carefully and watch your time closely.
- Part I contains objective questions. Part II requires a passage analysis, and Part III requires a brief essay.

PART I

(30 minutes, 10 marks)

(Each of the 20 questions in Part I is worth ½ mark.)

This part of the examination tests your knowledge and understanding of the fundamentals of correct writing. For each of the four sections, place your answers in the spaces provided to the left of each question. Do not linger over any one question too long. If you have time left at the end of the exam, go back and check any questions that puzzled you.

Part I: Section A—Identifying Sentence Fragments

Each of the following groups of words is either a correct sentence or a sentence fragment. Identify each group as one or the other by writing one of the following numbers in the space provided to the left of the question:

1. correct

2. fragment

- _____ 1. Whereas the real source of disdain remained concealed.
- _____ 2. He doesn't know which way is up.
- _____ 3. Particularly when the team uses a second-string goalie and—not to be overly critical—defensemen who play on the far side of the red line.
- _____ 4. The captain, who could never be accused of cowardice (or bravery, for that matter).
- _____ 5. Being 100 per cent without blame, in my opinion, particularly given his youth.

Part I: Section B—Punctuation and Mechanics

Each of the following sentences contains an error in punctuation or mechanics, or is correct. Indicate the error or the correctness by writing one of the following numbers in the space provided on the left:

1. if a comma has been omitted
2. if an apostrophe has been omitted
3. if quotation marks have been omitted
4. if the sentence is correct

- _____ 1. Yes, he said, "Don't worry about it."
- _____ 2. Carl's short story, *The End of the Innocence*, is submemorable.
- _____ 3. "You can go if you want" he said.
- _____ 4. Its a curious matter, but not insoluble.
- _____ 5. Bobs computer is malfunctioning, don't you think?

Part I: Section C—Identifying Comma Splice and Fused Sentence Errors

The following groups of words are either correct sentences, or they contain comma splice and fused sentence errors. Identify each word group by writing one of the following numbers in the space provided to the left of each question:

1. correct
2. fused sentence
3. comma splice

- _____ 1. You think the horses are within the barn, however, they left hours ago, in the company of a noted rustler.
- _____ 2. He was intercepted down by the canyon he looked different somehow.
- _____ 3. I felt confused by the assignment, often leaving myself open to criticism from my decided inferiors.
- _____ 4. I gave up on you long ago, I think most people would do the same.
- _____ 5. Once the contact is concluded we can begin work.

Part I: Section D—Grammar

Each of the following sentences contains either an error in grammar or is correct. Indicate the error or the correctness by writing one of the following numbers in the space provided on the left:

1. if the subject and verb do not agree
2. if a pronoun and its antecedent do not agree
3. if the sentence is correct

- _____ 1. England expects everyone to do their duty.
- _____ 2. The man that I shot was a public official.
- _____ 3. The costumes and the set was very effective.
- _____ 4. Either your mother or your father are going to be sacrificed
- _____ 5. There is many answers but few are conclusive.

PART II

(60 minutes, 35 marks)

This part of the examination tests your ability to write a detailed commentary in essay form on a passage of fiction. From the following passages, choose **ONE (1)** to write about. Write your passage analysis in your answer booklet(s) and complete these tasks:

- a. Identify the author and the story from which the passage comes.
- b. Examine the most important or striking details of the passage itself. Depending on the passage, point out details on character and characterization, setting, conflict, style, and narrative point of view.
- c. Include a clear thesis statement that explains the importance of the passage in terms of the rest of the story. Depending on the passage, show how it contributes to theme, to character, to conflict, or to setting.

Remember that you have approximately **ONE (1) hour** to write your passage analysis. Planning your analysis is very important. You won't have much time to revise. Be sure to divide your ideas into clearly focused paragraphs.

1. She looks at the paintings, she looks into them. Every one of them is a picture of Lucy. You can't see her exactly, but she's there, in behind the pink stone island or the one behind that. In the picture of the cliff she is hidden by the clutch of fallen rocks toward the bottom, in the one of the river shore she is crouching beneath the overturned canoe. In the yellow autumn woods she's behind the tree that cannot be seen because of the other trees, over beside the blue sliver of pond; but if you walked into the picture and found the tree, it would be the wrong one, because the right one would be further on.

Everyone has to be somewhere, and this is where Lucy is. She is in Lois's apartment, in the holes that open inwards on the wall, not like windows but like doors. She is here. She is entirely alive.

2. They were older when they married than most of their married friends; in their well-seasoned late twenties. Both had had a number of affairs, sweet rather than bitter; and when they fell in love – for they did fall in love – had known each other for some time. They joked that they had saved each other “for the real thing.” That they had waited so long (but not too long) for this real thing was to them a proof of their sensible discrimination. A good many of their friends had married young, and now (they felt) probably regretted lost opportunities; while others, still unmarried, seemed to them arid, self-doubting, and likely to make desperate or romantic marriages.
3. He doesn’t answer. The belt is coming off; not hastily. It is being grasped at the necessary point. All right you. He is coming over to Rose. He pushes her off the table. His face, like his voice, is quite out of character. He is like a bad actor, who turns a part grotesque. As if he must savour and insist on just what is shameful and terrible about this. That is not to say he is pretending, that he is acting, and does not mean it. He is acting, and he means it. Rose knows that, she knows everything about him.
She has since wondered about murder, and murderers. Does the thing have to be carried through, in the end, partly for effect, to prove to the audience of one—who won’t be able to report, only register, the lesson—that such a thing can happen, that there is nothing that can’t happen, that the most dreadful antic is justified, feelings can be found to match it?
4. She had suffered badly during the period of poverty. Nothing, however, could shake the curious, sullen, animal pride that dominated each member of the family. Now, for Mabel, the end had come. Still she would not cast about her. She would follow her own way just the same. She would always hold the keys of her own situation. Mindless and persistent, she endured from day to day. Why should she think? Why should she answer anybody? It was enough that this was the end, and there was no way out. She need not pass any more darkly along the main street of the small town, avoiding every eye. She need not demean herself any more, going into the shops and buying the cheapest food. This was at an end. She thought of nobody, not even of herself. Mindless and persistent, she seemed in a sort of ecstasy to be coming nearer to her fulfillment, her own glorification, approaching her dead mother, who was glorified.

PART III

(90 minutes, 55 marks)

Write an essay on **ONE (1)** of the following topics. Remember to include a strong thesis statement in your introduction.

1. “Desperation is the surest path to making a decision, good or bad.” Discuss (1) with reference to *Pride and Prejudice* **or** (2) with reference to “Barn Burning” and one other short story from the course.
2. If we accept the notion that a story is a self-contained whole, then the opening of the story should suggest many of the elements that will be featured throughout. Discuss with reference to *Pride and Prejudice* or with any two short stories from the course.
3. Hemingway doesn’t give much away in “Hills Like White Elephants,” whereas Faulkner is downright chatty. Discuss the effect of the narrator’s choice of point of view in any two stories from the course.
4. To what extent is nature itself a character in *Pride and Prejudice* or any two stories from the course?
5. “Tragedy is not the only genre in which characters reveal a tragic flaw.” Discuss this statement with reference to either *Pride and Prejudice* or two short stories you have studied in ENGL 1001.

END OF PRACTICE EXAMINATION